328

10 February 1954

Cis Office

MEMORANDUM FOR: Technical Services Staff

FROM : Chief, Operations Staff, O/SI

SUBJECT :

(72014)

1. Attached there is an OO-3 report concerning LSD,
for your retention, which you may not have seen. Paragraph
7 has some interesting implications and I wonder whether
you will want to follow-up on them or we should take action.
When you have looked it over, could you phone me about this?

[illegible] D/AD/SI [illegible]

Attachment:
As stated

Distribution:
Orig & 1 - Addressee
1 - Subject [illegible]
1 - Chrono
1 - Daily Reading + file TSS

(Ops note: cy of OO-B also sent to AD/SI on 10 Feb. 54 for Info. and return for Ops file)

(328)

TRANSMITTAL SLIP

10 Febr 1951
(Date)

TO: (1) Dr.

BUILDING

(2) Ops-([illegible])

ROOM NO.

REMARKS:

_______ - This is an interesting report, particularly para. 7. Am sending a copy to
with the suggestion that he may want to follow up.

FROM:

BUILDING	ROOM NO.	EXTENSION

FORM NO. 36-8
SEP 1948

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CENTRAL INTELLIGENCE AGENCY

INFORMATION REPORT

REPORT NO. 00-B-72014

JRY

ECT Conversation with

RESPONSIVE TO	
1	2
CD NO.	
00/C NO.	13184
CRR NO.	
OAS NO.	3038
OCI NO.	

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SOURCE)

ACQUIRED
SOURCE) Early Dec 53

(OF INFO.) Early Dec 53

DATE DISTR. 26 JAN 5

NO. OF PAGES 2

NO. OF ENCLS.

SUPP. TO
REPORT NO.

THIS IS UNEVALUATED INFORMATION

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the source

On 8 Dec 53 I had dinner in New York City with who is his now, I believe, the US representative of pharmaceutical house. During the course of the evening, drank a fair amount of bourbon and led the conversation. He has a curious and tiresome tendency to lard all that he has to say to me with flattery. On this occasion he constantly referred to a fairly recent article of mine which appeared in a scientific periodical and the impact of this article on pharmacological thinking in Europe. I do not know what the point of this flattery was; probably nothing more than the fact that is a rather small individual who has made his way in the world by getting on well with people. Perhaps this is how he accomplishes it.

He brought up the following matter in such a persistent way that I could not help wondering just what his motives were. At a previous meeting with almost a year earlier in Washington, he brought up the same matter in very much the same persistent way. So far no ready explanation has occurred to me for his persistence other than that he is keenly interested in the matter. After several drinks, he launched rather [illegible] into the subject: (this quotation is accurate) "The Pont Saint [illegible] 'secret' is that it was not the bread at all. For weeks the French [illegible] our laboratories with analyses of bread. It was not [illegible] ergot, it was a [illegible]-like compound." He referred here [illegible] to the well-known episode in France where a good many villagers were poisoned, so it was said, by ergot in the grain they used to make bread. I asked him ~~how the material~~ got to the people if it was not in the bread, he replied ~~"That we~~ do not know." He reviewed what he said to [illegible] a year earlier in Washington that he thought the whole business was a [illegible] experiment presumably by the French Government.

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talked further about LSD. "We [   ] are still very much interested in LSD." He went on to say, "one small reason I am here [in the US] is to dispose of our LSD." He said "if war breaks out our LSD will disappear."

I asked him casually if anybody else in Europe was interested in separating out the ergot alkaloids. He said that they were being produced by ~~the~~ another large pharmaceutical firm in

I asked   if he had any new agents he might like me to test. He said, "one of our principal interests is in searching for an LSD antidote. We have a brom-LSD compound. In the waltzing mice at least it checks the LSD's action. We do not yet know about its effect in man, as to whether it will act as an antidote to LSD."   remarks on this subject were very interesting to me because of a conversation I had in   in September 1953 with   , a pharmacological associate I had asked the same question of him during our meeting and he stated that they had a new lysergic acid derivative but that it had not turned out well.   obviously did not wish to talk about the subject. It is possible, however, that the brom-LSD compound mentioned by   is the same as the one referred to so vaguely by

Since our meeting in early December 1953   has returned to

[redacted]

It is interesting to speculate about the work of   and his wife in the ergot field.   is a very competent scientist and he and his wife originally used to collaborate on experiments on the ergot derivatives. His wife was formerly in love with a rather influential Communist in   . This man, is, I believe, now dead but apparently his philosophy made a very deep impression on her and her present beliefs based on this former association have contributed I believe to the break-up of her marriage to   who is certainly no Communist. It would be interesting to know whether or not   wife has continued her Communist associations and also whether or not information on her husband's experiments have been passed on through any such associations.

-end-

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